The threat comes not only from Lashkar as a stand-alone group or from its collaboration with other actors. Rather, individuals or factions within the organization can utilize its domestic infrastructure as well as transnational capabilities to pursue their own operations. Because members who leave do not necessarily cut ties with the group, or may bring elements within it with them, the threat also comes from Lashkar's alumni network. Thus, when assessing the dangers of Lashkar's expansion, one must consider the capability of current and former members both to steer the organization in an increasingly internationalist direction as well as to leverage its infrastructure for these purposes whether or not the leadership approves. Further, enhanced organizational integration with other outfits also heightens the opportunities for freelancing, thus increasing the chances that some of the group's capabilities might be used for attacks without the leadership's consent.

Lashkar's threat to India remains greater as well as more straightforward. After a period of calm following the Mumbai attacks, evidence suggests Lashkar's leash was loosened once again. The potential costs to the group for attacks against India remain lower than for its global jihadi activities because they are less likely to result in ISI sanction and so Lashkar is able to plan, prepare for and operationalize attacks against India with greater ease. Thus, the threat to Pakistan's neighbor is not simply about the likelihood or frequency of attacks, but also their scale since Lashkar can more fully capitalize on its extensive organizational capabilities for these operations. Moreover, although degraded, it appeared at the time of writing that the indigenous terrorist network in India that Lashkar helped to build was being regenerated with the help of external support. The Indian Mujahideen network is part of a wider jihadi project in India, and many indigenous militants have connections to multiple actors in Pakistan. On the whole, however, Indian jihadis are closest to Lashkar, which continues to train and support them. Although it appears the ISI remains able to influence Lashkar to modulate its terrorist activities vis-à-vis India, the group's regional presence in the Gulf as well as other South Asian countries means that its ability to inflict damage is not limited to what it can accomplish from Pakistan. While Lashkar's transnational networks can be used for multiple purposes and Western security officials are therefore correct to worry about the threats they pose to their own countries, the group still employs them primarily for attacks in India.